

performance (about as much as today's Intel processors and just two standard household light bulbs).

Intel plans to gain a better understanding of how to schedule and coordinate the many cores of this experimental chip for its future mainstream chips. For example, future laptops with processing capability of this magnitude could have 'vision' in the same way a human can see objects and motion as it happens and with high accuracy.

World's thinnest LCD TV panel

LG Display has developed the world's thinnest LCD TV panel measuring 2.6mm. The development of slim LCD panel was possible by applying the company's accumulated 'slimming' technologies including the use of an ultra-slim, edge-lit LED backlight system and proprietary optical film technology.

The 106.7cm panel weighs less than 4 kg and offers 120Hz refresh rate technology with full HD (1920 x 1080) resolution for clear and sharp image. LG Display will showcase the product and its new display technologies during the upcoming Consumer Electronics Show (CES) 2010 in Las Vegas.

Dell revamps Inspiron Mini 10

Dell's Inspiron Mini 10 netbook is getting better with a fresh new look and longer battery life to go along with technology enhancements and easy connectivity capabilities. Updates to the Mini 10 include optional high-definition entertainment bundles that deliver smooth playback of streaming HD video in addition to Web surfing, e-mail, listening to music and sharing user-generated content in real time.

The new design with 25.6cm display includes a textured, smudge-resistant palm rest, sculpted keys and, for the Inspiron Mini 10 mobility bundle, extended-life battery offering up to 9.5 hours of operation.

It will be offered in a selection of bundles with distinct features like an HD display, Broadcom Crystal HD media accelerator, surround sound capability, built in HDTV tuner for over-the-air local HD broadcasts, or built-in Wi-Fi location enabled GPS. Some models feature Bluetooth and Mobile Broadband communications, too.

Dell expects the redesigned Inspiron Mini 10 to be available in early January.

Ford to introduce Wi-Fi in cars

Ford is planning to add Wi-Fi to some of its models. Starting in 2010, Sync-equipped Ford cars will not only use currently available communications technologies (such as hands-free calling, audible text messages and real-time traffic) but also support Wi-Fi Protected Access version 2 (WPA2).

Using the Sync Wi-Fi system, a signal will be broadcast throughout the vehicle. WPA2 requires users to enter a randomly chosen password to connect to the Internet. When Sync sees a new Wi-Fi device for the first time, the driver must specifically allow that device to connect, preventing unauthorised users.

The Windows-powered Ford Sync currently helps users to operate their mobile devices with steering wheel and radio controls. Sync also supports advanced features like Text-to-speech and voice recognition technologies.

Acer plans 10 new smartphones in 2010

Acer is planning to introduce around 10 new smartphones in 2010, with Android-powered models likely to be slightly more than Windows Mobile-based ones. According to sources, the company will outsource the production of three Android-based smartphones to Foxconn International Holdings (FIH), using the ST-Ericsson PNX6719 3G chipset for the entry-level segment.

On the other hand, Inventec Appliances will be tasked to make

entry-level Windows Mobile-based smartphones. Acer is also considering in-house development of smartphones using Qualcomm's fast Snapdragon processors.

New module for bench oscilloscopes

Tektronix has announced the DPO4USB module for triggering and analysis on USB serial buses—claimed to be an industry first for bench oscilloscopes. The DPO4USB module addresses a key challenge facing today's embedded design engineer—the explosion of USB buses both for system-to-system and chip-to-chip communications.

The module complements the MSO/DPO4000 Series oscilloscopes and automates key measurement and analysis tasks on USB 2.0 low-speed, full-speed and high-speed buses, enabling engineers to more quickly troubleshoot and debug their designs for a faster time to market.

It addresses the needs of designers integrating USB 2.0 buses into the products ranging from toys to medical equipment and industrial systems to digital cameras and video recorders.

ISRO plans to launch 8 foreign satellites

The Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) has eight foreign satellites in its pipeline, which are expected to be launched over the next two-three years. The space agency is scouting to acquire such spacecraft from different countries to meet its growing needs of communication transponders.

The details about the satellites are yet to be disclosed. These comprise a mix of both small and bigger satellites out of which a 150-kg one from Algeria is slated to be launched in April next year.

ISRO earned over one billion rupees in the last three years by launching satellites of other countries. It launched 12 foreign satellites during the last three years, including six nano satellites.

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